

September merges rose 69% YoY to 144 as 32.0rc2 entered testing — Sebastian Kung merged 42%.

WHAT SHIPPED

Wallet: Add importdescriptors interface (#34861); Wallet: Add `maxfeerate` wallet startup option (#29278).

REVIEW HEALTH

125 human reviewers (-7% YoY); median time-to-merge 6.9d (12-mo median 8.2d).

GOVERNANCE

Merges by Sebastian Kung 42%, Michael Ford 35%, Ava Chow 16%. 424 PRs open at month end, 62 older than a year.

PRs merged · bitcoin/bitcoin

144

▲ +69% YoY
vs 85 in Sep '25



12-mo median 110 · band = p10–p90

Median time-to-merge

6.9_d

▲ +38% YoY
p90: 126.4d

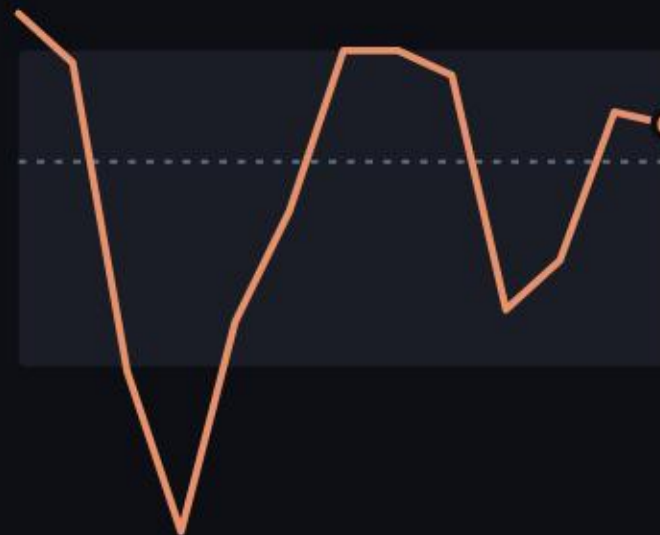


12-mo median 8.3d · band = p10–p90

Active human reviewers

125

▼ -7% YoY
vs 134 in Sep '25

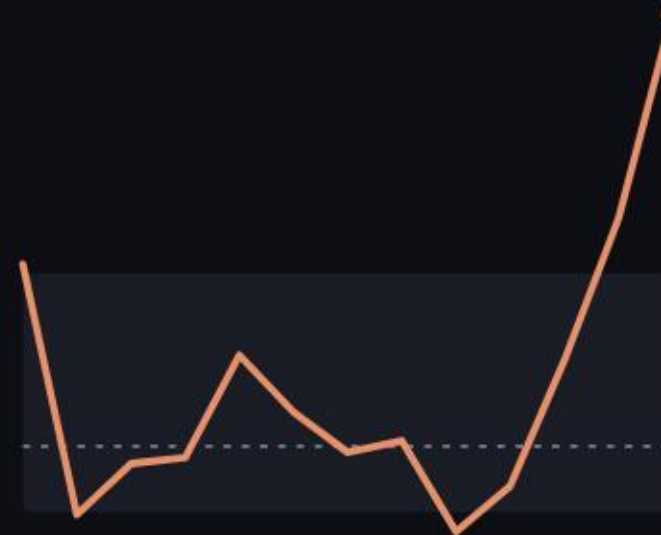


12-mo median 122 · band = p10–p90

Open PR backlog (month end)

424

▲ +12% YoY
median age 70d · 62 older than 1 yr

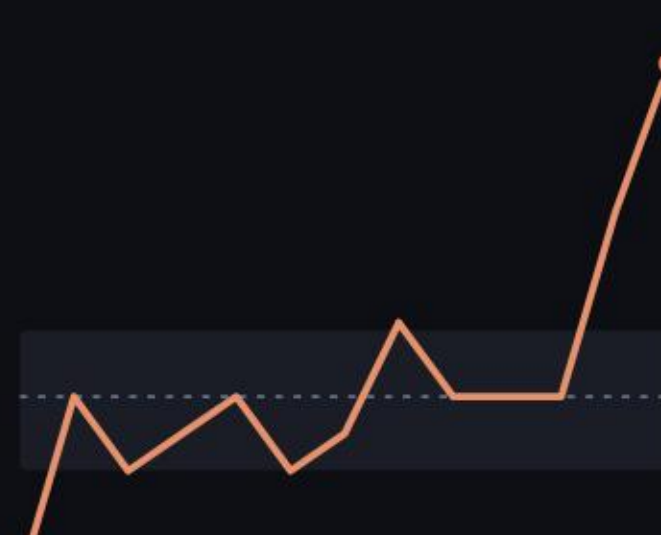


12-mo median 348 · band = p10–p90

First-time merged contributors

15

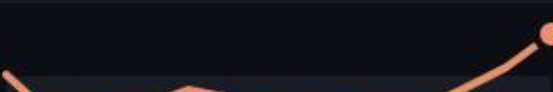
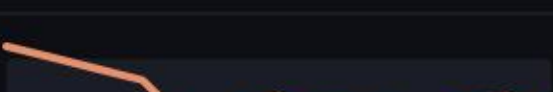
▲ +14 vs a year ago
27 opened their first PR this month



12-mo median 6 · band = p10–p90

13-month development scorecard: every metric against its own trailing-12-month band

Scope: **bitcoin/bitcoin** for every row except the two labelled gui / secp256k1 merge rows.

GROUP	METRIC	SEP	MOM	YOY	12-MO MEDIAN	13-MO TREND	STATUS
THROUGHPUT	Merged PRs (bitcoin/bitcoin)	144	-3.4%	+69.4%	110		● Normal
	Merged PRs (bitcoin-core/gui)	0	-3	-2	2		● Normal
	Merged PRs (secp256k1 library)	12	-1	+1	8		● Normal
VELOCITY	Median time-to-merge (p50)	6.9d	+1.1d	+1.9d	8.2d		● Normal
	Long-tail time-to-merge (p90)	126.4d	+28.3d	+90.1d	158.4d		● Normal
REVIEW RIGOR	Unique human reviewers	125	-0.8%	-6.7%	122		● Normal
	Substantive review comments	2,151	+4.8%	+33.0%	1,796		● High
	Median unique ACKers per merged PR	3.0	+1.0	+0.0	2.0		● High
BACKLOG	Open pull requests (month end)	424	+9.3%	+11.6%	348		● High
	Open PRs older than 90 days	185	-3.6%	-21.6%	200		● Normal
GOVERNANCE	Top maintainer merge share	41.7%	-12.0 pts	-12.4 pts	48.5%		● Normal
	Self-merges (excl. backports & subtrees)	3	-3	-12	6		● Normal

144 PRs merged; Testing & QA (17%) and Build & CI (15%) took the largest share of merges

MOST-REVIEWED MERGES

BY HUMAN REVIEW COMMENTS

WALLET & USER TOOLS

#34861 wallet: Add importdescriptors interface

This PR introduces a new interface for importing output descriptors into the wallet, making it easier and more reliable to manage complex sets of add...

91 review comments · 5 ACKs · by Pol Espinasa

#29278 Wallet: Add `maxfeerate` wallet startup option

This PR introduces the `maxfeerate` wallet startup configuration option to Bitcoin Core.

71 review comments · 4 ACKs · by Abubakar Sadiq Ismail

#35436 wallet: Add addHDkey interface

This PR introduces a new `addHDkey` RPC interface to the wallet, allowing users to import individual Hierarchical Deterministic (HD) keys.

51 review comments · 5 ACKs · by pseudorandom

MAINTENANCE & TECH DEBT

#33593 guix: Use UCRT runtime for Windows release binaries

This PR updates the Guix build system to use the Universal C Runtime (UCRT) for Windows release binaries.

65 review comments · 3 ACKs · by Hennadii Stepanov

NETWORK & PRIVACY

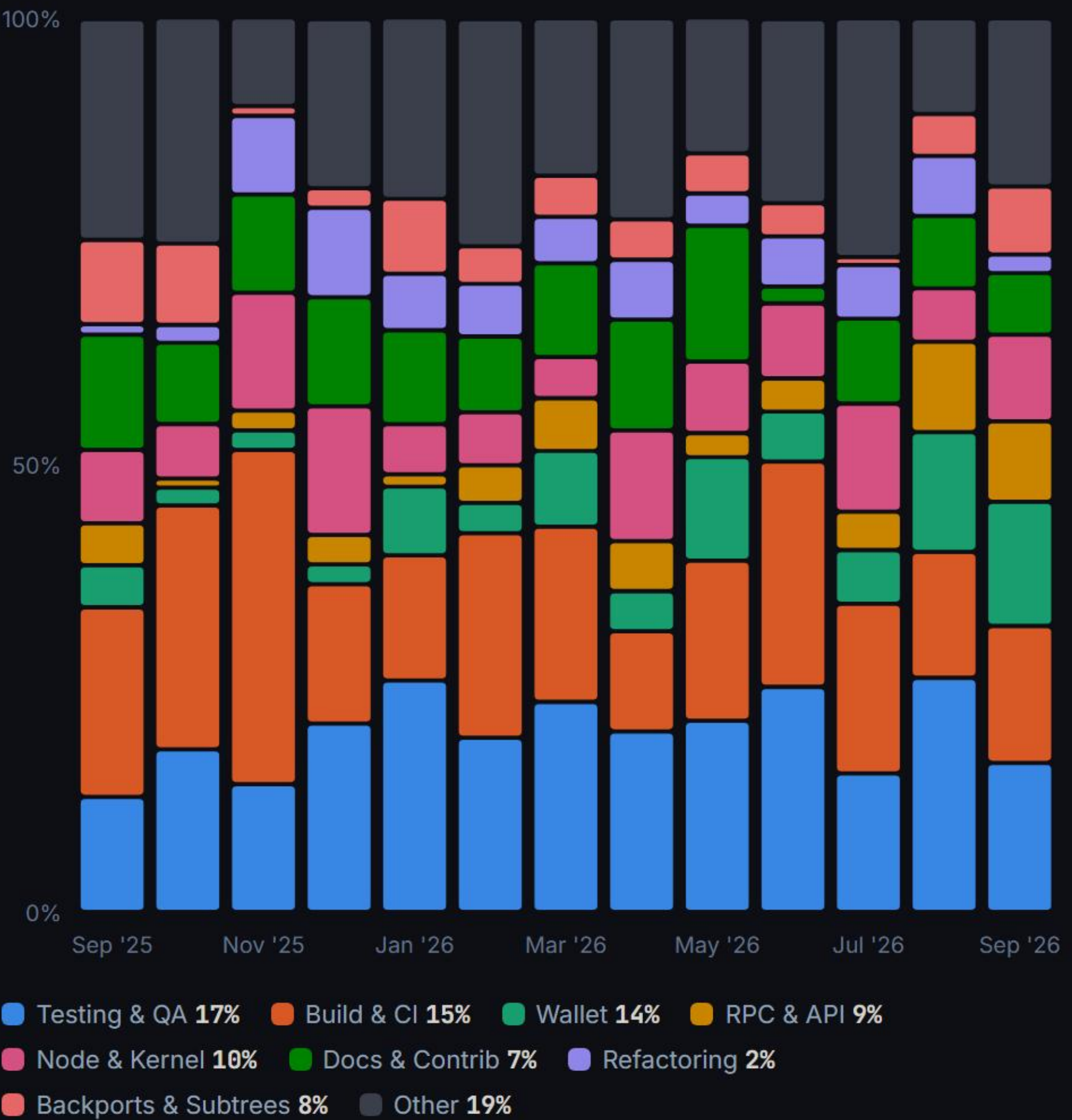
#35301 Silent Payments: Implement bip352 (take 2)

This PR advances the implementation of BIP352, the specification for Silent Payments, within Bitcoin Core.

51 review comments · 3 ACKs · by Oghenovo Usiwoma

SUBSYSTEM SHARE OF MERGES

13 MONTHS · % OF MERGED PRS



Bitcoin Core 32.0 is in release-candidate testing (32.0rc2) with 4 milestone PRs open

TRACKING ISSUES

TASK COMPLETION

Multiprocess #28722	83%
226/273 tasks · Russell Yanofsky · updated 2026-09-16	
Erlay #30249	53%
9/17 tasks · Sergi Delgado Segura · updated 2026-07-29	
SENDTEMPLATE #33691	38%
5/13 tasks · Anthony Towns · updated 2026-08-28	
Mining Interface #33777	38%
5/13 tasks · Sjors Provoost · updated 2026-07-23	
MuSig2 #31246	100%
14/14 tasks · Ava Chow · updated 2026-04-29	
Cluster Mempool #30289	100%
33/33 tasks · Pieter Wuille · updated 2026-02-25	

RELEASE RADAR

32.0

Release candidate testing (32.0rc2)

Milestone PRs closed	123
Milestone PRs open	4
PRs in release	627

RELEASE HIGHLIGHTS

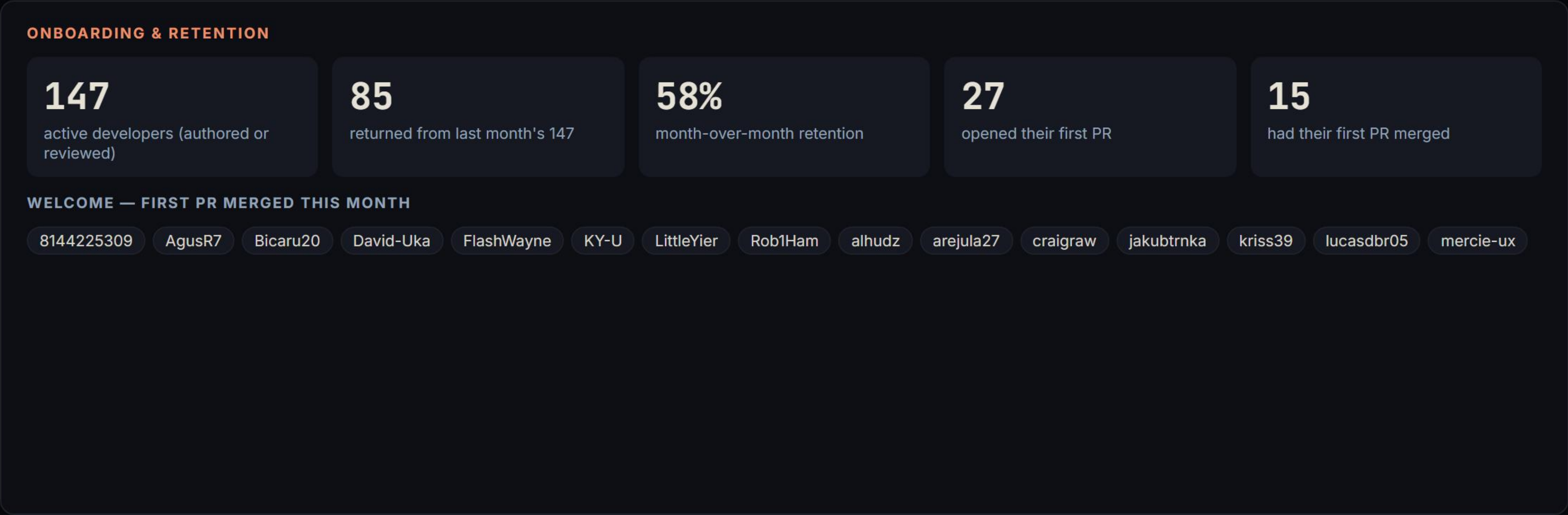
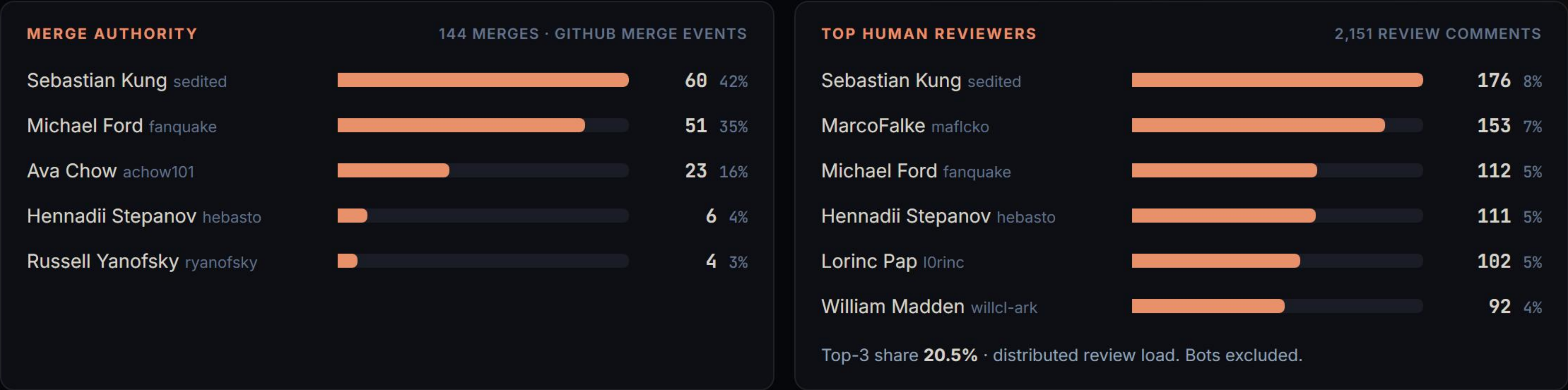
For Wallet Developers & Users: This release significantly upgrades wallet capabilities with the implementation of BIP 370 PSBTv2, enabling more flexible and complex transaction construction, alongside new RPCs for granular HD key control and improved descriptor handling.

For Node Runners: Performance and resource efficiency are boosted through parallel fetching of transaction prevouts during block validation, leading to faster initial block download, reduced disk space for the transaction index (``txindex``), and optimized UTXO cache management with a new ``dbcache`` setter.

OPEN ON THE 32.0 MILESTONE — REVIEW & TEST

- #36277 net: always complete all initial private broadcast connections · andrewtoth
- #36303 http: Log bytes received from client, use to replace receive-throttle regression test · pinheadmz
- #36340 util: cap Sock::WaitMany timeout to fix -rpcclienttimeout=0 on macOS · kriss39
- #36427 [32.x] More Backports · fanquake

3 maintainers merged 93% of PRs; the top 3 reviewers wrote 21% of review comments



Quantum / PQC led 12-month protocol discussion; 58 threads active in September

TOPIC HEATMAP

ACTIVE THREADS PER MONTH · DELVING BITCOIN + BITCOINDEV MAILING LIST

	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	
Quantum / PQC	1	7	14	14	31	11	36	39	15	13	11	9	201
Taproot	16	6	2	2	2	13	10	6	4	12	3	4	80
Mining / Stratum v2	7	7	8	4	6	4	3	2	8	14	8	3	74
Covenants	1	3	8	5	12	6	12	4	1	1	3	4	60
Mempool & Fees	11	3	6	3	10	5	6	3	5	1	3		56
UTXO & Sync	9	4	5	1	2		1	20	5	1	2	1	51
BIP Process	1	19	5	5	1		1	2	2		5	1	42
Core Dev	14	3		4	1	1	3	2	4	5	1	3	41

MOST ACTIVE DISCUSSIONS

34 DELVING · 24 MAILING LIST

DELVING

Bounds on chain length with BIP-54 timewarp fixes

28 messages · Pieter Wuille, Zawy

DELVING

PQC output type discussion

21 messages · Antoine Riard, conduction, Pieter Wuille

DELVING

Standardizing an exposure classification for existing outputs (pre-BIP)

14 messages · Duncan0k, Anzus, Murch

MAILING LIST

Standardizing public key exposure classification for existing outputs

4 messages · duncan0k, conduction

DEV MEETING HIGHLIGHTS & NEXT STEPS

4 MEETINGS

Fuzzing Working Group: dergoegge announced his departure from full-time contribution, with his projects and security contact responsibilities transitioning to Brink's Ma...

QML GUI Working Group: johnny9dev reported ongoing work on design, issue resolution, and staging, with no significant updates this week.

32.0 Release Candidate Testing: sedited announced the availability of 32.0rc2 binaries for community testing.

REVIEW ASKS · 32.0 MILESTONE

#36277 net: always complete all initial private broadcast connections

#36303 http: Log bytes received from client, use to replace receive-throttle regression test

#36340 util: cap Sock::WaitMany timeout to fix -rpcclienttimeout=0 on macOS

#36427 [32.x] More Backports